

Hackathon Platform – Infra Cost Estimate (Aug–Oct 2026)

Prepared by: Kishlaya (System Architect)

This is a transparent estimate of the infrastructure cost to **run the hackathon platform during the three active months: August, September, and October 2026**. Development is 80% done; this budget focuses on **running the live platform during hackathon months**, not the earlier build phase.

As discussed by Nikhil, company can transfer this budget once, and I'll handle purchasing and managing the subscriptions (Supabase, Resend, Vercel, domain, analytics) and keep all invoices/receipts organized.

1. Email Infrastructure – Resend

- **Service:** Resend (transactional email API)
- **Usage:** registration emails, team invites, submission confirmations, result notifications
- **Plan:** Pro – **\$20/month**
- **Duration:** 3 months (Aug–Oct)
- **Cost:** $\$20 \times 3 = \60

This covers up to ~50,000 emails/month, which is more than enough for >10k participants and all transactional/notification mail during the hackathon period.

2. Database / Auth / Storage – Supabase

- **Service:** Supabase (Postgres + Auth + Storage)
- **Usage:** core database, authentication, and file storage for submissions
- **Plan:** Pro – **\$25/month**
- **Duration:** 3 months (Aug–Oct)
- **Cost:** $\$25 \times 3 = \75

The Pro plan gives us a production-grade Postgres instance with higher limits and better stability during peaks in registrations and submissions.

3. Hosting – Vercel

- **Service:** Vercel (Next.js hosting)
- **Usage:** hosting frontend + API routes (single codebase)
- **Plan:** Pro – **\$20/month** (1 active seat)
- **Duration:** 3 months (Aug–Oct)
- **Cost:** $\$20 \times 3 = \60

The Hobby plan is free, but Pro removes important limits and is more appropriate for a serious global hackathon platform during live traffic.

4. Domain

- **Service:** Domain (e.g. .com)
- **Usage:** primary public URL for the platform
- **Cost:** **\$25** (1 year, including taxes/SSL variations)

Typical .com domains are in the \$10–20 range; budgeting \$25 is a safe upper bound including taxes, SSL and registrar differences.

5. Analytics – Plausible

- **Service:** Plausible Analytics
- **Usage:** privacy-friendly analytics for visits, conversions, and funnels during the hackathon
- **Plan & usage:**
 - \$9/month if we stay under **10k pageviews/month**
 - \$19–39/month if we reach higher traffic tiers (up to ~200k pageviews/month)
- **Budget assumption for 3 months: \$50–\$100 total**

This covers a mix of lower and higher traffic months during August–October, giving us enough visibility into traffic, conversion, and performance without over-spending.

6. Miscellaneous / Rounding / Fees

- **Item:** Payment processor GST, FX rounding, pricing quirks
- **Reason:**
 - Most services bill in **X.99** formats, and payment gateways add small currency conversion spreads.
 - There may be minor variations in tax/VAT and invoice rounding between months/providers.
- **Buffer: \$20**

This buffer ensures small variations (like \$0.99 extra on multiple invoices) don't break the budget.

7. Summary (Aug–Oct 2026)

- **Resend Pro (3 months):** \$60
- **Supabase Pro (3 months):** \$75
- **Vercel Pro (3 months):** \$60
- **Domain (1 year):** \$25
- **Plausible (3 months, est.):** \$50–\$100
- **Misc. buffer (GST/FX/rounding):** \$20

Total budget range for the 3 hackathon months:

- **Lower bound:** about **\$290**
- **Upper bound:** about **\$340**

If you're okay with this range (we can take the upper bound for safety), you can transfer a single amount once, and I'll handle:

- Activating and managing Pro plans during August–October

- Keeping invoices/receipts organized
- Making sure we stay within or under this budget while running the platform reliably for the hackathon.